DRILL 13

SEARCH & RESCUE

NFPA 1001 Level 1 (JPR 4.3.9) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

VICTIM DRAGS, CARRIES & WINDOW REMOVALS

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Any Engine/Rescue | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear & Gloves

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | 2-Firefighter Rescue Teams

🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter must be able to rapidly extricate an unconscious or incapacitated victim from a structure using the **Webbing Drag**, **Bunker Coat/Collar Drag**, **Two-Person Extremities Carry**, and remove a victim through a standard ground-floor residential window. Moving dead weight with gloved hands is an exhausting physical skill that requires exact leverage and team coordination.

📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- 150-lb rescue mannequin or weighted dummy (or paired firefighters taking turns as "patients").
- 20-ft section of 1-inch tubular webbing tied into a continuous loop (water knot) for each member.
- Station window prop, doorway threshold, or low ladder setup.
- Exercise mats or clear floor area.

⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **Back & Spinal Ergonomics:** Rescuers must lift with their legs and keep their backs straight. No twisting under heavy spinal loads!

⚠️ **Head & Neck Support:** Protect the victim's head from bouncing or dragging against door saddles, concrete stairs, or rough asphalt.

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: Shout "STOP!" immediately if a rescuer slips, feels acute lumbar strain, or if a live participant acting as a victim is pinched or dropped.**

PHASE 1: SOLO RESCUER DRAGS (15 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. **The Webbing Drag (Girth Hitch Method):**
   - Loop a 20-ft continuous webbing strap beneath the victim's back/armpits.
   - Pass the ends through the center loop to create a snug chest harness (girth hitch) around the torso.
   - The rescuer turns forward, places the webbing loop over their shoulder or across their chest, and leans forward to drag the victim using leg drive. Rescuer's hands remain free to hold a flashlight or feel walls!
2. **The Bunker Coat / Shirt Drag:**
   - Used when webbing is not immediately in hand.
   - Cross victim's arms across their chest.
   - Rescuer kneels behind victim's head, grasps the heavy fabric of the coat/collar behind the neck, lifts victim's head and shoulders onto rescuer's thighs to protect the skull, and walks backward.

DRILL 13: PRACTICAL EVOLUTIONS & TAILGATE DEBRIEF Search & Rescue • Practical Application

PHASE 2: TWO-PERSON EXTREMITIES CARRY (15 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

1. **Rescuer 1 (Torso / Head):**
   - Kneels behind victim, lifts torso to sitting position.
   - Reaches both arms under victim's armpits and grasps victim's crossed wrists firmly.
2. **Rescuer 2 (Legs):**
   - Kneels between or alongside victim's legs facing the direction of travel (or facing rescuer).
   - Slips arms under victim's knees.
3. **The Lift & Move:**
   - Rescuer 1 calls cadence: *"Ready to lift... 1, 2, 3, LIFT!"*
   - Both lift using leg muscles, keeping victim horizontal, and carry down hallway to exterior doorway.

PHASE 3: GROUND-FLOOR WINDOW REMOVAL (20 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. **The Window Siphon:**
   - Interior crew maneuvers victim to the windowsill.
   - Rescuer 1 lifts victim's torso and drapes victim's chest and arms over the windowsill facing outside.
   - Exterior firefighter(s) grasp victim under armpits/arms, pulling torso outward and downward over the sill.
   - Interior firefighter supports victim's legs and guides them over the sill, preventing snagging.
   - Lower victim gently onto a ground tarp outside.

⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ❌ *Pulling by wrists or ankles without supporting head:* Dragging a relaxed unconscious victim by the feet allows their head to bounce violently across floors and door thresholds, causing secondary trauma.
- ❌ *Bending at the waist during lifts:* Catastrophic back strain occurs when twisting while bent over. Keep hips square and drive with quads and glutes.
- ❌ *Losing grip due to sweaty/wet gloves:* Bare hands on sweaty skin will slip; use clothing, belts, or webbing straps to secure a mechanical grip.

🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"Which drag allowed you to move the fastest with the least effort?", "How much easier was the webbing harness compared to dragging by clothes?"***

✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- ☐ Webbing straps inspected, rolled, and returned to bunker pants pockets.
- ☐ Rescue mannequins stowed.
- ☐ Gear wiped down.
- ☐ Attendance roster signed.

DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE	SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE	DATE COMPLETED	TRAINING HOURS